Read the text and do the activities:

A DIGITAL BOOM

Multimedia enhances the way people work, learn, play, and most importantly, communicate. It is not a new medium, but rather old individual media that have come to life together in new **formats** on new **devices** and for new personal uses. There are many lessons that the print world, storytelling, music and film production can offer about how to make multimedia work as a unified interactive **experience.**

You are probably involved with multimedia in some way. Many of you may be developing multimedia as an extension to your existing work, for example in software development, or consulting. Other people are on the periphery of the multimedia industry; they are vendors, distributors, and information providers in publishing, music, art, and education.

Something extraordinary is happening on a global **scale**. Five mega-industries (personal computing, consumer electronics, publishing, entertainment, and telecommunications) are converging.

This merging of different disciplines is amazing. For the first time, we use a common format. Today, the information for each one of these industries is available in digital **formats**, stored in bits and bytes. Almost everything we see on TV, read in print, view at the theatre, and receive over wires or airwaves is easily accessible and available anywhere, at any time. We are experiencing a digital boom!

One of the great challenges with this array of digital information is to provide interfaces and searching mechanisms that allow people to select this information. Multimedia represents intuitive and realistic ways for people to sort through this digital web - to represent this "content" to **consumers** who are not programmers or "digital scientists". It also represents ways for people to customize their interaction with the digital **world** so that the **information** they receive through their senses makes the most sense to them - be it aural, visual, tactile, kinetic, or a **combination** of these. Think of multimedia as an enhancement to the way people communicate.

Comprehension questions:

Determine if the following sentences are True (T) or False (F)

- Multimedia is a completely new medium that has never existed before.
- The print world, storytelling, music, and film production have nothing to contribute to multimedia.
- Many people are involved in multimedia either as developers or as part of related industries.
- The convergence of different industries is leading to a digital boom.
- Digital information is only available in physical formats like books and CDs.
- Multimedia helps people interact with digital information in ways that suit their senses.

Answer the following questions based on the text:

1. Which five industries are merging due to digital technology?
2. What is one major challenge of digital information mentioned in the text?
3. In what ways does multimedia help people interact with digital content?
4. According to the text, who are some of the people involved in multimedia besides developers?

Translate these sentences. The first sentence in each group is from the text above:

1. -Multimedia enhances the way people work, learn, play, and most importantly, communicate.

   -The play we saw at the theatre last Saturday was brilliant.

2. -This merging of different disciplines is amazing.

   -We need to discipline these new students.

3. -For the first time, we use a common format.

   -The use of new technologies encourages people to work in a different way.

4. - Almost everything we see on TV, read in print, view at the theatre, and receive over wires or airwaves is easily accessible and available anywhere, at any time.

   - The view from my hotel room is amazing.

NOUNS, ADJECTIVES or VERBS?

a) What types of words are underlined? _____

b) What types of words are highlighted? _____

c) What types of words are in bold? _____

C. Put the words into the correct parts of speech category.

big moved sat good old quickly slowly woman rain dog quietly red

writes worked little runs child noisily car cold fell sister badly hard

Verbs	Nouns	Adjectives	Adverbs

continue	The rain started at 9pm and _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*verb*) through the night. It rained _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adverb*) from 9pm until 7am.
cover	Most mornings, the ground is _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*verb*) with dew. In winter, the mountains have a _ _ _ _ _ _ (*noun*) of snow.
damage	In 1988, Cyclone Bola caused a lot of _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*noun*) on the East Coast of the North Island. The cyclone _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*verb*) buildings, forests and farms. Some of the _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adjective*) buildings could no longer be used.
explode	Air in storm clouds can _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*verb*) when it becomes hot. An _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*noun*) usually makes a very loud noise.
fierce	A typhoon is a _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adjective*) storm. Winds blow _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adverb*) around the centre of a typhoon.

flood	Heavy rain caused the river to _ _ _ _ _ _ (*verb*). The _ _ _ _ _ _ (*noun*) covered roads and water came into houses. The _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adjective*) ground took weeks to dry out.
freeze	When raindrops _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*verb*) they form hailstones. Hailstones are _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adjective*) rain. It was _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adjective*) outside, so we decided to stay inside.
loud	The thunder grew _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adjective*) and _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adjective*) as the storm came closer. The siren sounded _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (*adverb*) to warn of the emergency.